

BIS Certification Marks Scheme — Overview (Standard Mark)

Purpose

The BIS Certification Marks Scheme operates under the Bureau of Indian Standards Act and provides third-party assurance of product quality to Indian Standards. Manufacturers whose products conform to the relevant standard may apply for a licence to use the Standard Mark (commonly called the ISI mark). The mark signals conformity of the product with the applicable Indian Standard at the time of testing.

Application Process

A manufacturer applies with details of the product, plant, test facilities and quality control system. The application is reviewed, samples are drawn and tested in an independent laboratory, and a pre-inspection of the manufacturing unit is conducted. On successful completion the licence is granted with conditions, including annual renewal. Schemes differ by product sector; some products fall under Compulsory Certification (schedule of Indian Standards).

After the Licence

Licensed units are subject to surveillance visits and market surveillance testing. The licence can be suspended or cancelled for non-conformity. Consumers can verify the mark; misuse of the mark is an offence under the Act. BIS also operates a Laboratory Recognition Scheme, Hallmarking for precious metals and a Consumers' Grievance redressal mechanism.